2020

Annual General Meeting Booklet

Bicycle Newfoundland & Labrador

AGENDA

Bicycle Newfoundland & Labrador

Annual General Meeting

Date: Saturday, April 4, 2020
Location: Meeting to be held by distance
Time: 10AM-12Noon

1) Call to Order/Welcome

2) Review of AGM Minutes 2019

3) Reports
   - Annual Report by President
   - Year End Financial Report

4) Covid-19

5) Newfoundland and Labrador Summer Games

6) Proposed Amendments to Constitution & Bylaws

7) Nominations Report & Election of Directors

8) Discussion

9) Closing Comments

10) Adjournment

MINUTES ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

Date: Saturday, April 6, 2019
Location: Swilers Club, 100 Crosbie Road, St. John's
Time: 10AM-12Noon

Registration of Attendees:

Kevin Flynn	Laura Flynn	Mel Fitzgerald
Ted Correa	Don Boyles	Kirk Tilley
Scott Andrews	Eric Skoglund	Calvin Matchim
Adam Churchill	Ryan Butt	Glen Smith
Chris Boyce	Lawrence Penney	Keith Manuel
Tony Diez	Dave Hammond	Mick Cutler
Jenn Wicks	John Hancock	Rachelle Cochrane

1) Call to Order/Welcome
   - Kevin called the meeting to order at 1005hrs. and welcomed everyone. He also mentioned that the TriNL President has sent us Best Wishes for a successful AGM.

2) Reports:
   - <u>Annual Report by President</u>
     The President gave an overview of the annual report which was previously circulated to the membership and which is also available from the bicyclenl website. Highlights from the report included:
     - A thank you to two new sponsors arising out of the recent sponsorship campaign. These are **Leon's Furniture** as a Silver Level Sponsor for a contribution of $5,000 and **Robert Conway** (Co-operators agent) as an Annual Optional Level Supporter for a contribution of $1,000.
     - BNL is partnering for the second year in a one-day Cycle for Sight riding event in August for the charity "Foundation Fighting Blindness". Registration is free for BNL members.
     - Recognition of Colin Fowlow as the Bicycle Newfoundland and Labrador provincial Road Cycling Champion after a heated competition in the 2018 Tour du Port au Port.

   - <u>Year End Financial Report</u>
     Don gave an overview of the highlights of the BNL year-end financial report.

     Discussion: Although the annual report showed a healthy ending bank balance, that money includes the two recent sponsorship donations. It also includes grants which must be spent on specific initiatives related to the Canada Games and Recreation (e.g. Parasport). Additionally, we anticipate further Cycling Canada expenses from the 2018 year which we have not yet been billed for.

Some comments/questions arising from the report are as follows:

Question: Why were fees increased this year?
Response: A breakeven analysis is done each year. This year it showed that BNL was losing money on two membership categories, which accounted for the increased fees. The net profit from memberships on the financial statement is showing as $456.79 this year, about $1.00 per person. (As all the fees from Cycling Canada are not yet in, that figure could be lower).

Question: How do fees in this province compare with other provinces?
Response: Fees are generally much higher in the rest of the country although it is sometimes hard to compare. For example, a couple of provinces use a different insurance provider so their insurance fees could possibly be lower for some membership categories. As well, most, if not all, of the other bicycle associations across the country receive substantial annual grants from their provincial governments to spend on operations whereas BNL in this province receives a very small grant.

3) Proposed Amendments to Constitution & Bylaws
   - Laura gave some background about a couple of the proposed amendments to the March 16, 2018 BNL Constitution & Bylaws which had previously been distributed to the membership.
     Moved by Glen Smith and seconded by Mick Cutler that the proposed changes be adopted as distributed. Majority voted in favour. MOTION CARRIED.

4) Nominations Report & Election of Directors
   A previous call for nominations for various Director positions resulted in the following nominations:
   - Director (Treasurer) – Don Boyles
   - Director (Secretary) – Laura Flynn
   - Director of Marketing and Communications – Ryan Green
   - Director of Non-Competitive Cycling – Scott Andrews
   - Director of Competitive Cycling – John Hancock
   - Director of Women's Cycling – Christine Elliott
   - Director of Youth Cycling – Andy Poole

As there was one nominee per position, the positions could be accepted by acclamation and Kevin assumed the role of Elections Officer. He asked if there were any objections to declaring the candidates elected to office. **Since there were no objections, the candidates were elected by acclamation.**

Two of the board positions (Kevin as President and Ted Correa as Director of Coaching) are not due up for nomination at this time.

Two of the director positions (Ryan Green and John Hancock) are new and Kevin welcomed them to the board.

Maggie O'Keefe (Director of Marketing and Communications) and Ryan Butt (Director of Competitive Cycling) resigned from the board this year and Kevin thanked them for their many contributions to BNL.

Kevin also thanked the remaining board members as well as the Regional Representatives {Timothy Mackenzie (Western), Mark Pinhorn (Central), Eric Skoglund (Labrador) and Chris Boyce (Eastern)} for their contributions to the organization and the growth of BNL.

5) Discussion

Question: What are the plans for hosting the Canada Games in 2025? To be eligible we need to have coaches in places with the required courses, etc.
Response: We will continue with the development of coaching as it is today and start a program for the development of officials.

Comment: BNL will be submitting an application for cycling to be a part of the 2020 NL Summer Games.

Comment: Lawrence Penney thanked Kevin and BNL members for their support of the Cycle for Sight ride as well as the tandem bike rides for the visually impaired. The 2019 Cycle for Sight event is scheduled for the same date as the St. John's Triathalon which may negatively affect participation. Suggestion that the date be changed.

Question: Kirk asked if BNL can offer a workshop on basic bike maintenance.
Response: Challenges in implementing as one-on-one assistance needed, fairly large venue, etc. Need volunteers to implement. Ryan Butt indicated he is trying to arrange a workshop possibly in May.

Comment: Mick thanked Ryan for his many contributions to BNL, particularly in arranging some of the rides such as the Grand Fondo in Port Rexton.

Comment: Mel Fitzgerald thanked Kevin as well as the 50+ riding group for their support to him and other paracyclists. He also thanked Kevin for lobbying with the town councils which resulted in a change of ATV barriers on the trail in Paradise to a model that facilitates hand cycles. He also spoke about the need for funding for a hand cycle that can be used on the trail for the benefit of newcomers.

Comment: Adam Churchill gave an update on a couple of issues:

- The feasibility study that was done on a mountain biking operation in the White Hills in Clarenville. Adam is a member of the board looking at this issue. As the report indicated that the cost would be very high, it is unlikely to go ahead. The board is still contemplating doing the project on a smaller scale, however.
- The Avalon Mountain Biking Association (AMBA) is working to legitimize the White Hills area and all the mountain biking trails in the Eastern region. If anyone can contribute in any way, let him know.

6) Closing Comments
   - Kevin thanked everyone for coming and for their input into the meeting.

7) Adjournment
   - The meeting adjourned at 1110hrs.

Approved by BNL Executive - April 25,2019

Annual Report from President - Kevin Flynn
Bicycle Newfoundland & Labrador
April 1, 2019 - March 31, 2020

MEMBERSHIP

I would like to acknowledge Bicycle Newfoundland and Labrador (BNL) members for having purchased a general membership or a UCI license in 2019. Membership grew from 458 in 2018 to 658 in 2019, making 2019 another year of phenomenal growth for the organization. The continued growth in membership is primarily attributed to the increased number of sanctioned and approved events as well as to the work of committed BNL volunteers.

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

I would like to thank the Board of Directors and the Regional Representatives for their commitment and hard work towards promoting bicycling and the goals of BNL in the province. Thank you as well to the many other volunteers who assisted with the activities and events of the organization.

Governance and Strategic Planning

The Board continues to work towards achieving its goals as outlined in the three-year Strategic Plan spanning 2018 to 2020. It includes a vision and mission statement, a mandate and the following five strategic directions for the organization:

1. Education and Awareness
2. Organizational Governance
3. Marketing and Communications
4. Financial Sustainability
5. Partnership Development

CHANGE IN FEE STRUCTURE

Heading into 2020, we have pleased to be able to maintain status quo with respect to membership fees. We have added two new membership categories (**Provincial Racing under 17** and **Provincial Racing 17+)**. Please note that members holding a Provincial Racing License can only race in the province of NL. Attached is a breakdown of membership fees for 2020. BNL membership fees continue to be low compared to other provincial bicycle associations across the country. Please note that we made slight changes to some of the membership category names this year in order to be consistent with the rest of Canada.

BNL Membership Fees - 2020	
GENERAL MEMBERSHIP	
Age Category	**Fee**
Under 19 years of age	$30
19+ years of age	$40
UCI RACING LICENSE	
Age Category	**Fee**
UCI under 17 years of age	$45
UCI 17+ years of age	$65
Provincial RACING LICENSE	
Age Category	**Fee**
Provincial under 17 years of age	$35
Provincial 17+ years of age	$65

CHANGE IN INSURANCE STRUCTURE

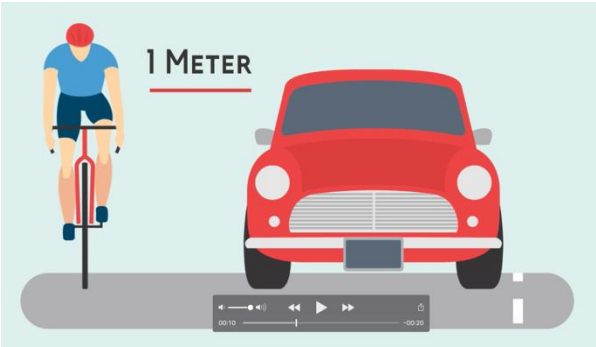
BNL has joined into a new co-operative insurance agreement with several other provinces as the previous contract has ended. The provider, Holman's Insurance www.cyclyinginsurance.ca , remains unchanged although the program will no longer be operated through Cycling Canada.

DIGITAL LICENSES

In 2020 digital licenses will replace the plastic and paper cards. Members are required to download their digital license and have a digital copy available at all events.

SAFETY VIDEOS

In 2018-19 Bicycle Newfoundland and Labrador successfully lobbied the provincial government to pass legislation and bring into law the "One Metre Rule". The new rule, which came into effect on March 5, 2019, is an important step towards protecting cyclists and pedestrians in the province and BNL is proud to have helped make it official. BNL subsequently developed an educational video to help promote safety and the law. The organization is seeking funding to develop additional videos promoting various aspects of safety for cyclists.



BNL WEBSITE

We continue to promote BicycleNL through the website www.bicyclenl.com the official 'face' of the organization. We strive to keep the website updated and aim to continue with timely updates in the coming year.

NEW POLICIES

BNL, through the Board of Directors, developed and introduced two new policies in 2019: The "Club Affiliation Policy" and a "Travel Reimbursement Policy". Work is also under way to develop a Privacy Policy. Thank you to Board members Scott Andrews, Eric Skoglund and others for their work in developing the policies. These policies address important issues to cycling organizations across the country and provide consistency in decision-making within BNL.

CANADA GAMES

Coaches for the 2021 Canada Games NL Cycling teams continue to do a wonderful job in preparing for the Games. The coaching team consists of five members - Ted Correa (Director of Coaching), Mick Cutler, John Hancock, Jenn Wicks and Andy Poole. The Canada Games Coaching Team held very successful athlete identification camps in Eastport in the spring and summer of 2019. Coaches are continuing their individual training and certification programs. The plan is to work with coaches in the Atlantic provinces and Cycling Canada to arrange competitive training events for the athletes.

NL SUMMER GAMES

For the first time ever, the sport of cycling (mountain and road) will be part of the NL Summer Games. In addition, the sport of Para-cycling will be a demonstration sport in the 2020 NL Summer Games. Identifying volunteer coaches and managers for these sports in the eight regions throughout the province has been a challenge. To help solve the problem, BNL has created the contractual position of "NL Games Coordinator". The primary responsibility of the Coordinator is to identify individuals to act as coaches & managers for both mountain bike and road cycling in the identified 2020 NL Games regions.

PARTNERS & SPONSORS

Partners

BNL has many partnership relationships. For example, it is a member of Cycling Canada, the national governing body of cycling racing in Canada. It is also a member of Canada Bikes, a not-for-profit corporation which has a mandate to make cycling attractive, safe and accessible across the country.

Other partnerships include the Newfoundland T'Railway Council, a non-profit organization dedicated to the development of a recreational trail across the island using the former Canadian National Railway line. BNL partnered with the provincial Department of Children, Seniors and Social Development in the development of a community resource guide and with School Sports Newfoundland and Labrador (SSNL) to extend youth involvement in cycling in the province.

BNL continues to partner with the NL-Visually Impaired Sports and Recreation Association (NL-VISRA), the Canadian Council of the Blind (CCB), Recreation NL and ParaSport NL to offer bicycle riding sessions for the physically impaired. BNL partners in the Cycle for Sight annual bicycle ride to raise money for vision education and research through the nonprofit organization Fighting Blindness Canada.

Various cycling stores in Newfoundland and Labrador offer a 10% discount on non-sale bicycle accessories such as clothing and other items at the discretion of the shop. The discount is available to current members of BNL. A new partner, Moda Yoga St. John's, also offers a 15% discount on membership as well as 5 or 10-class cards to current BNL members.

Sponsors

BNL would like to extend a sincere thank you to the following sponsors for their generous support which allows us to maintain existing programs, offer new ones and support our athlete teams:

- Leon's Furniture – Silver Level Sponsor

- Robert Conway, Co-operators agent
- NL Balance and Dizziness Centre
- Karl Smith

To find out more about our sponsorship program, go to http://bicyclenl.com/partners/

VOLUNTEER APPRECIATION

For the third year in a row, BNL held a Volunteer Appreciation Event which was well attended by volunteers, sponsors, partners and board members.

REGIONAL ACTIVITIES

As outlined below, BNL initiated or participated in a variety of cycling events and initiatives in 2019/early 2020.

Eastern

- Once again, the **Short Track Series** was a great success. Over the course of several weeks, riders, young and old, came together for a whole lot of cycling fun! An entertaining evening of races was held each Thursday throughout the duration of the series. Numbers grew each week, particularly among young children.
- The **Pouch Cove Classic** was a resounding success this year thanks to the hard work of Ted Correa and his team. This year two para-cyclists competed in the grueling event.
- The **Weekly Group Road Ride** in St. John's was successful. Organizers interested in leading a ride may review relevant information and access required forms from the BNL website at http://bicyclenl.com/events/#group_rides .
- The **Trepassey Posse**, a cycling ride in the southern Avalon, was an approved event for BNL again in 2019. Participants braved the challenging hills of the Southern Shore experiencing high winds, fog and blistering sunshine over the two-day ride. The ride is planned to go ahead again in June, 2020.
- In the fall of 2017, BNL joined forces with NL-VISRA to organize a two-day cycling training session for the visually impaired and para-cyclists. BNL members volunteered again this past year to further develop pilot skills for a tandem bicycle team. Ten **Tandem Bicycle Group Ride** sessions were held in 2019 with the last four taking place on the T'Railway. BNL received a grant to purchase a tandem bicycle. The success of the rides led BNL to team up with VISRA to enter a team in the Paradise Triathlon.
- Several **Women on Wheels** rides were held throughout the year. BNL encourages women to come forward to organize and lead these rides for 2020 as there is an interest in keeping them going.

- BNL participated in the **SportFest** at the Kids & Family Expo in June 2019. Volunteers set up and manned a booth which allowed children to try cycling on a computerized trainer. There were also demonstrations in bicycle maintenance.
- BNL participated in organizing and implementing the **Pippy Park Fatbike Festival**, held in mid February, which had 58 participants. A second event **Tour de Summit** held in Clarenville in late February was attended by approximately 50 cyclists. This event was coordinated with the Clarenville Cross Country Ski Club.
- The **50+ Group Rides** continue to be very successful. Members aged 50 and over gather each Wednesday morning to cycle and socialize. As the weather was very cooperative this year, the rides continued until December with an average of 30 participants per ride. A guide "Guidelines for Group Ride Leaders" was developed to provide direction to group leaders.
- The **Bicycle Newfoundland and Labrador Pippy Park Liaison Committee (BNL-PPLC)** was formed this year. This is a committee of volunteers interested in grooming trails in the winter and helping to maintain them during the summer months. Terms of Reference were developed. The Committee also launched a fundraising initiative to purchase equipment for spring/summer trail grooming.
- An **iBike Camp** took place on Saturday, June 29th from 9am-12pm at the Pearlgate Track & Field Complex in Mount Pearl. The Camp included fun biking skills, obstacle courses, games and prizes. Adults and children aged 6+ with disabilities or challenges learning to ride participated in the camp.
- The **St. John's Enduro Series** was composed of an exciting series of three enduro mountain bike races in Pippy Park and White Hills in St. John's. Organizers of the successful event are aiming to expand to a provincial series in 2020 with races in the St. John's and Corner Brook regions.
- For the third year in a row, BNL partnered with **Cycle for Sight** for their one-day ride event which took place on August 11. The event includes 25km, 50km and 75km options, as well as 3-12km options for children. A 25km trail ride was also included this year. The event raises money for vision research in Canada.

Central

- The successful **Bon Rexton Gran Fondo** was held again this year on the Bonavista Peninsula with 150 participants enjoying a non-competitive road ride.
- The **BNL Provincial Road Race** was held in Eastport in September 2019 with a small, but competitive, field of cyclists. The winners were Ian Coxon, Men's Provincial Champion, Vicki Parsons, Women's Provincial Champion and Roughan Gaetz, U19 Men's Provincial Champion.

- BNL partners with School Sports Newfoundland and Labrador (SSNL) through two separate programs: (a) **Participation Nation** which is a program that promotes children participating in activities during the after-school time slot in a fun, inclusive, and non-competitive environment. They have adopted Sprockids as one of their two outdoor programs. To date they are supporting 16 school-based programs, with a reported enrolment over 200; (b) SSNL held the second **Pedal to the Medal** event in Clarenville in June, 2019. This event hosted six schools and over 40 athletes participating in a sprint series mountain bike race. Medals and banners were awarded for both the Junior and Senior High School category winners. Following the event, SSNL voted to include mountain biking as a 2019 Demo Sport. With increased growth the sport the goal is for cycling to become a full-fledged calendared and supported SSNL sport. The 2020 race in Clarenville is scheduled for June and a second event is being discussed for St. John's.
- Plans are to reach out to more communities in the region, to promote cycling and to host more local events.

Western

- Thirty-five girls aged 6-14 participated in a **Young Female Riders Group**. Weekly road and mountain biking (MTB) rides for women were very popular.
- The successful annual **Impact Time Trial** and **Road Race** took place in Pasadena in June. The top cyclists for the Time Trial and Road Race were Ian Coxon, Carl Barrett and leading the field of female competitors was Vicki Parsons. The Impact event will take place again in May 2020. Congratulations to all the participants and organizers of the event.
- The town of Stephenville hosted a trail building workshop on May 11 at the Stephenville legion. The workshop was facilitated by IMBA trail building specialist Justin Truelove.
- Tuesday night **Fatbike rides** at Blow Me Down Cross Country Ski Club facility are going well – A reminder that this is a pilot project to examine the feasibility of offering fat bike riding at the club.
- The **Cruise the Cape Gran Fondo** and the **Mini Fondo Fox Island Recovery Ride** were a welcome addition to the Fondo series this past year. Plans are well underway for the 2020 event.

Labrador

- **Weekly Mountain Bike group rides** took place from the Minipi Outfitters sporting goods store over the summer months from June 12th to September 25.th
- The **Bike Park Maintenance & Repairs program** continued again from June to August.
- The **Iron City Duathlon** took place in Labrador City on June 16th.
- The **Goose Deuce Duathlon** was held on Aug 18th.

- The **Annual Bike Rodeo** occurred on Aug 24th.
- A **Family Bike Ride** took place on Oct 6th.

SUMMARY

Thank you again to everyone who contributed to the work of BNL in the past year. The continued success of the organization is dependent upon the commitment and hard work of many volunteers as well as sponsors, individual donors and partners throughout the province. Without the efforts of these dedicated individuals, the organization would not be able to grow and to operate as successfully as we do.